

Weekly Writing - Week 1

Maxwell Mccort

8/30/2025

1. Text of the prompt or title of your writing topic goes here(Is it better to do all coding in class with AI tools, and focus more on concepts, or, is it better to learn the actual code through trial and error?)

I believe its good to have a mix of both. Computers are better than humans at doing computer work, so I think we should use them to make our lives easier as best we can. Why have computers otherwise? I think AI is especially useful for coding in careers outside of CS/DS, where coding might not be the sole focus. For someone like me, who plans on using R to create box/whisker plots, run ANOVA tests, t-tests, etc... Its less important to understand all of R's mechanics. However, I do think its very important to understand the code you are using. If you don't know what a t-test is, and you don't understand R, then you have no way of verifying your work. In short, people who plan on coding **as** their career should learn the nitty gritty, and people who plan on using coding **in** their career should at least be able to understand what the code does.

For this class specifically, I think the target audience is mostly people who plan on using coding **in** their careers, rather than **as** their careers. I think the system that's already in place for this class works well, where if we use AI, we have to cite/explain what its doing. Through this method, we build the skills necessary to use code, whether its written by a human or not.